FY 2025 Traditional Public-Private Partnership Program
(Education and Culture Program 2025): Budget Narrative

Partners of the Americas

Partners of the Americas (POA) has prepared a budget as requested by the U.S. Department of State Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs (ECA). The budget requests a total of $244,129 from ECA. POA will provide $73,870 for a total program budget of $317,999.

POA has established sound financial management and internal control systems, ensuring expenditures are allowable and classified in accordance with internationally accepted accounting principles. POA employs a fully automated accounting system and has annual A-133 audits. The Finance and Administration (F&A) department is staffed with a talented group of professionals with years of experience related to financial administration and reporting. The finance department is made up of a Director of Grants & Contract, two financial accountants, and a Chief Financial Officer (CFO) with over 40 years of experience in the fields of finance and accounting, auditing, managing the financial reporting aspects reporting aspects of US Government (USG) grants and contracts, and has significant experience overseeing cooperative agreements. The F&A team works closely with project staff at POA's headquarters (HQ) to monitor spending, ensure costs are allowable, and support implementation of the project in accordance with USG rules and regulations (particularly 2 CFR 200), local laws, as well as POA's internal policies. Our accountants also review spending with project directors monthly and assist with oversight of sub-recipients, end-of-project reporting, and other aspects of project monitoring.

POA uses a robust and cost-effective strategy to determine cost allocation in accordance with USG cost principles, local laws, and internal policies. Our proposed budget for this project was developed by conducting thorough price analyses to identify realistic and fair market values for all projected expenses. Our budget estimates were also calculated based on experience in implementing effective and cost-efficient USG-funded programs. The following budget narrative will provide an in-depth explanation of each line item presented in the budget.

- Individual line items are discussed below following the budget table format requested in the Proposal Submission Instructions.
- Travel costs have been estimated from a survey of airline quotes, USG per diem and lodging rates, and are not specified until final participant selection takes place.

Partners of the Americas
FY 2025 Educational and Cultural Exchange Programs // Partners of the Americas' Education and Culture Program

Assistance Listing 19.415 / Funding Opportunity #DFOP0017214

Table A1: Estimated Unobligated Funds

Grant Program Function	Federal	Non-Federal	Total

Participant Costs	**$84,779**	**$20,000**	**$104,779**
Participant costs per participant	$4,239	$1,000	$5,239
Non-Participant Support Costs	**$159,350**	**$53,870**	**$213,220**
Non-Participant costs per participant	$7,968	$2,693	$10,661
Total Costs	**$244,129**	**$73,870**	**$317,999**
Total costs per participant	$12,206	$3,693	**$15,900**
Number of participants	20		

Section B: Budget Categories

Table B1: Grant Program Function or Activity			
Budget Categories	***Federal***	***Non-Federal***	***Total***
1. Personnel	$ 76,086	$ -	$76,086
2. Fringe Benefits	$ 17,857	$ -	$17,857
3. Travel	$ 71,898	$ -	$71,898
4. Equipment			
5. Supplies	$ 234	$ 1,998	$2,232
6. Contractual	$ 39,200	$ 35,000	$74,200
7. Construction			
8. Other Direct Costs	$ 7,011	$ 36,872	$43,882
9. Total Direct Costs (lines 1-8)	**$ 212,286**	**$ 73,870**	$286,156
10. Indirect Costs*	$ 31,843	$ -	$31,843
11. Total Costs (lines 9-10)	**$ 244,129**	**$ 73,870**	$317,999

Salaries
Subtotal Salaries: $76,086
ECA Request: $76,086
Cost Share: $0

I. Salaries*

POA has budgeted for one (1) Senior Director and one (1) Associate Director at POA's headquarters. Proposed salaries are also consistent with those paid to other personnel

engaged in similar work within and outside of POA4% increase in 2026 and 2027 to account for inflation and merit increases for all staff, consistent with HQ policies. POA is budgeting salary at a limited LOE as indicated below, as some staff time will be split between the proposed Education and Culture program FY2025 and prior award Education and Culture FY2024 as they work to close the prior award and start implementation of the new award.

1. **Senior Director**, whose monthly salary is $12,168/month will provide technical guidance as required, supervise the Associate Director - Program Director, and support relations with DOS, ECA, PAS, and other stakeholders. From September 2025 to April 2025, the Senior Director will contribute 2.5% LOE to the program. Starting May 2026 and until February 2027, the Senior Director will contribute 5%. The total for the life of the project is **$8,860**.

2. **Program Director**, REMOVED**.**

3. The **Associate Director**, whose salary is $6,423/month will serve as the Program Director. She will be responsible for coordinating the day-to-day activities, supervising Program Support, interns, and volunteers, maintaining relations with DOS, ECA, PAS, and other stakeholders. She will also manage financial and programmatic issues for the program and monitor compliance. From January to April 2026, the Associate Director will dedicate 50% LOE, reporting the remaining 50% LOE to the existing Education and Culture FY2024 award. Starting May 2026 and until the end of the award, the Associate Director will dedicate 80% LOE to the project. The total for the life of the project is **$67,226**.

4. **Program Support.** REMOVED.

The PERSONNEL total is **$76,086.**

Fringe Benefits **Subtotal Fringe Benefits: $17,857** **ECA Request: $17,857**

II. Fringe Benefits*

Fringe Benefits US-based staff: In accordance with POA's personnel policy, a 23.47% fringe rate is applied to POA Headquarters staff salaries for staff based in the United States. This totals **$17,857.**

Fringe Benefits Colombia based staff: REMOVED

The FRINGE BENEFITS total is **$17,857.**

Travel **Subtotal Travel: $71,898** **ECA Request: $71,898**

Cost Share: $0

III.Travel

POA has contracted a travel agency to manage all staff and participant travel in compliance with the Fly America Act.

1. ***Staff Travel***

a. *Domestic Round-Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the U.S. and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. The domestic airfare is intended to be used for one (1) staff member to travel for site visits or other sponsored events two (2) times and two (2) group exchange facilitators to be present and coordinate the Washington, DC component of their exchanges. POA anticipates four (4) trips at **$**500 per round trip ticket. This totals **$2,000**.

Domestic Lodging & Per Diem: Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on the USG lodging and per diem rate in Washington, D.C., and other cities in the United States (the rate for the second city in the group exchange program is illustrative, as it is undecided). POA has budgeted $224/night for lodging in Washington, D.C. for four (2) nights for the Associate Director and two (2) group exchange facilitators. This totals $1,344. It also budgets a reduced USG per diem rate of $83/day for three (3) days in Washington, D.C. for each person. This totals $745. In addition, for the Associate Director, POA budgets $169/night for lodging for two (2) nights and $72/day in per diem for three (3) days in a second city in the United States. This totals $338 and $216, respectively. The total cost is **$2,643.**

b.

c. *International Round Trip Airfare*: Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences conducting monitoring visits for prior programs. POA anticipates one (1) trip at **$1,500** for a round trip Fly America act compliant ticket. The purpose of this trip will be to monitor program progress and attend international events to promote the Education and Culture Program. The total cost for POA staff international airfare is **$2,476**.

d. *International Lodging & Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for lodging and per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences conducting program visits for prior programs. POA has budgeted an average USG per diem rate of $68/day for six (6) days and $114/day for lodging for five (5) days. The total cost is **$976**.

2. ***Participant Travel***

a. *International Round Trip Airfare:* Budgeted costs for flights are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA anticipates 20 trips at an average cost of $1,600 per round trip Fly America compliant ticket for a total of **$32,000.**

b. *U.S. Domestic flights for Group Exchange Participants:* POA will encourage group exchange facilitator applicants to include a 2-3 day trip to Washington, DC as a part of the exchange agenda. If included, POA will cover U.S. flights from the host community, budgeted at $500 for 16 participants, totaling **$8,000**.

c. *International/Domestic Per Diem:* Budgeted costs for per diem are based on a sample of various cities throughout the region and past experiences implementing the Education and Culture award. POA estimates a reduced per diem rate of $80/day for 10 days each trip for a total of 20 trips. The daily per diem rate is intended to cover travel-related expenses such as meals and incidental costs. The total cost is **$15,960**.

d. *Visa Fees:* POA estimates visa expenses at a rate of $160 each for an estimated four (4) U.S. participants, for a total of **$640.** There are currently a several LAC countries that require visa for U.S. citizens. As POA is unable to predict to which countries U.S. citizens will plan to travel as part of the program, POA anticipates providing reimbursements for four (4) travelers. The Department of State will cover expenses related to the J-1 visas for approximately LAC participants.

e. *Visa-related Travel Fees*: To increase accessibility within the program, especially for prospective travelers from more rural areas in their countries, POA estimates providing a maximum of $250 per participant to assist in covering travel-related costs for visa appointments travel to/from the airport, and other miscellaneous travel expenses. POA anticipates four (4) participants at a maximum reimbursement of $250 each for a total of **$1,000**.

f. *U.S. Hotel for Group Exchange Participants:* POA will encourage group exchange applicants to include a 3-day trip to Washington, DC as a part of the exchange agenda. If included, POA will cover housing, budgeted at an average of $224 for 16 participants for two (2) nights, totaling **$7,179**.

The TRAVEL total is **$71,898.**

Equipment **Subtotal Equipment: $0** **ECA Request: $0** **Cost Share: $0**

IV. Equipment

No Equipment is considered in this proposal.

Supplies **Subtotal Supplies: $2,232** **ECA Request: $234** **Cost Share: $1,998**

V. Supplies

a. *Supplies:* POA is estimating $13/month for office supplies for 18 months, for a total of **$234**. In addition, POA will donate supplies for programming planning and implementation including one (1) computer budgeted and phone budgeted at **$1,998**.

The SUPPLIES total is **$2,232.**

Contractual **Subtotal Contractual: $74,200** **ECA Request: $39,200** **Cost Share: $35,000**

VI. Contractual

a. *Subawards for Community-Led Projects*: POA has budgeted for three (3) community-led project subawards at an average of $5,000 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $15,000. In-kind cost share will combine donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the subaward projects. The project subawards will support community-led initiatives aligned with the Program's objectives and ECA's strategic goals. The subawards will be for community-based organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$15,000.**

   The budgets for the subaward projects are not yet available as the recipients are selected via an open competition once the FY25 is awarded. Subrecipients are selected by POA, an external review committee and ECA. All subrecipients will be approved by ECA and flagged for U.S. Embassies in relevant countries.

b. *Subawards for Group Exchanges*: POA has budgeted for two (2) subawards to support group exchanges of at least eight (8) participants per subaward, at an average of $10,000 each. In addition, POA estimates in-kind cost share from subrecipients at $10,000/subaward for two (2) subawards. In-

kind cost share will combine donated volunteer time, supplies, and other materials to support the group exchange program. The group exchange subawards will support explicitly designed exchange programs aligned with the Program's objectives and ECA's strategic goals. The subawards will be for POA Chapters and organizations throughout the U.S. and Latin America. The total **in-kind cost share** provided is estimated at **$20,000**. Total ECA costs are estimated at **$20,000.**

The budgets for group exchange projects are not yet available as the recipients are selected via an open competition once the FY25 is awarded. Subrecipients are selected by POA, an external review committee and ECA. All subrecipients will be approved by ECA and flagged for U.S. Embassies in relevant countries.

c. *Technical/Operational Consultant Pool:* POA estimates working with various consultants to support Program activities and work with participants and subawardees on project planning, coordination, communications, etc, at a rate of $300/day for 14 days, for a total of **$4,200**. This is based on previous rates for specialized consultants with similar scopes of work.

d. *Monitoring and Evaluation Consultant:* REMOVED.

The CONTRACTUAL total is **$74,200.**

Other Direct Costs **Subtotal Other Direct Costs: $36,872** **ECA Request: $7,011** **Cost Share: $43,882**

VII. Other Direct Costs

1. *Events*

a. *Exchange Activities:* POA is budgeting **$2,000** to cover costs during group exchange activities in Washington, DC that are not covered by the facilitator. This could include event costs, meals with POA, and local transportation.

2. *Communications*

a. *Promotion & Communications:* POA is budgeting **$154** to increase Program awareness through communications pieces and marketing materials as part of its strategic communications strategy.

b. *Platform Subscriptions:* POA is budgeted for program specific subscriptions such as Microsoft 365, PandaDoc, Replicon, IT reimbursement, and Mentimeter, and other online tools to assist in program management. As the program overlaps partially between awards, POA is budgeting for

approximately $149/month, at 50% between September 2025 and April 2026 and 100% between May 2026 and February 2027 for a total of **$2,153.**

c. *Online Platform for Subaward Management:* POA is budgeting for an online subaward management platform for $139 for 18 months. This platform hosts and centralize all relevant programmatic resources including application and funding guidelines, financial templates, proposal writing tips, and grant management training materials. The platform allows applicants to track and save their applications and, if awarded, their reports. Additionally, it allows users to select their preferred language to view the application and grant materials. Based on current expenses and projected annual increases, POA is budgeting **$2,498.**

3. *Materials*

a. *Courrier and printing:* POA will be mailing PEX cards to United States addresses for 20 program participants so they may receive their per diem during their trip. This will support those who would otherwise not be able to afford meals and incidentals during the exchange. This line also will cover any printing or materials needed for the group exchange. This totals **$206.**

4. *Volunteer Time*

a. *Volunteer Time:* The POA will contribute $36,872 in volunteer time as cost-sharing throughout the project's life.

U.S. and LAC Volunteer Time				
Item	**# volunteers**	**# Vol-days**	**Daily Rate**	**Total Cost Share**
U.S. Volunteers				
Planning and preparation	2	2	$248.48	$994
Orientation	2	2	$248.48	$994
Participants	8	7	$248.48	$13,915
Follow-on engagement	2	5	$248.48	$2,485
Communications support	1	10	$248.48	$2,485
Proposal reviewers	5	5	$248.48	$6,212
Sub total				**$27,084**
Non-U.S. (LAC) Volunteers				
Planning and preparation	2	2	$71.44	$286
Orientation	2	2	$71.44	$286
Participants	12	7	$71.44	$6,001
Follow-on engagement	2	5	$71.44	$714

Communications support	1	10	$71.44	$714
Proposal reviewers	5	5	$71.44	$1,786
Sub total				**$9,787**
Total volunteer time match				**$36,872**

POA's accounting system for volunteer time operates under the principle that the person must directly report the actual time volunteered using standard forms (timesheet) and guidelines. POA does not count estimates of volunteer time and our approach is conservative—if there is a reasonable doubt about the validity of submitted hours, POA does not count them. POA has divided time valuation into the three categories stated below. This approach to valuing volunteer time in each of the categories listed below has been reviewed and approved by our auditors:

1. Volunteers who reside in the U.S. POA values its volunteers as cost share as they are professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled labor which are an integral and necessary part of the program. To properly value contributed services from United States volunteers, POA bases the valuation on fair market value. To derive the fair market value, POA bases it on the most recent Occupational Employment Statistics provided by the Bureau of Labor Statistics for all occupations (https://www.bls.gov/oes/current/oes_nat.htm#00-0000). Based on the specialized services provided by individuals with those skills (as they indicate on their signed timesheets), the mean hourly rate will be used to calculate the total value of their contributed services. This valuation is compliant with the 2 CFR 200 which states: *Volunteer services furnished by third-party professional and technical personnel, consultants, and other skilled and unskilled labor may be counted as cost sharing or matching if the service is an integral and necessary part of an approved project or program. Rates for third-party volunteer services must be consistent with those paid for similar work by the non-Federal entity. In those instances, in which the required skills are not found in the non-Federal entity, rates must be consistent with those paid for similar work in the labor market in which the non-Federal entity competes for the kind of services involved. In either case, paid fringe benefits that are reasonable, necessary, allocable, and otherwise allowable may be included in the valuation.*

   For U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) volunteers each for the following activities: two (2) days for planning and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and thirteen (13) days for follow-on engagement. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. In addition, POA is budgeting one (1) person volunteering ten (10) days for communications support, such as drafting social media posts, writing blogs, and making short videos to highlight the program. POA is also budgeting eight (8) volunteer participants for seven (7) days. Finally, POA is budgeting five (5) days for five (5) proposal reviewers across Community-Led Project Funding, Group

Exchange Facilitation Funding, and exchange participant opportunities. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. Given the expertise of these individual POA is estimating an average of $31.06/hour which, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, is the average hourly rate for educational training professionals. **The total cost share contribution is $27,084**.

2. Volunteers who reside in Latin America and the Caribbean. For non-U.S. volunteers POA is budgeting two (2) volunteers for each of the following activities: two (2) days for planning and preparation, two (2) days for orientation, and two (2) days for follow-on engagement. Based on experience implementing this type of program, POA has calculated eight (8) hours per day. In addition, POA is budgeting one (1) person volunteering ten (10) days for communications support, such as drafting social media posts, writing blogs, and making short videos to highlight the program. POA is also budgeting twelve (12) volunteer participants for seven (7) days. Finally, POA is budgeting five (5) days for five (5) proposal reviewers across Community-Led Project Funding, Group Exchange Facilitation Funding, and exchange participant opportunities. The actual number of hours that each volunteer spends executing the program, however, will be carefully documented following uniform POA guidelines and reported to ECA with the final report. To create a similar fair market value estimate for POA volunteers in non-U.S. countries, the GNI per capita for each country (as reported by the World Bank and adjusted for inflation and purchasing power parity) was used to calculate the volunteer time. The resulting hour value for non-U.S. time is approximately $8.93 per hour (or $71.44 per day). **The total cost share contribution is $9,787**.

The OTHER DIRECT COSTS total is **$44,082.**

Indirect Costs **Subtotal Indirect Costs: $31,843** **ECA Request: $31,843**

VIII. Indirect Costs

POA is negotiating a new NICRA rate and are proposing a reduced rate of 15% of total direct costs. Total indirect costs for this program is **$31,843.**